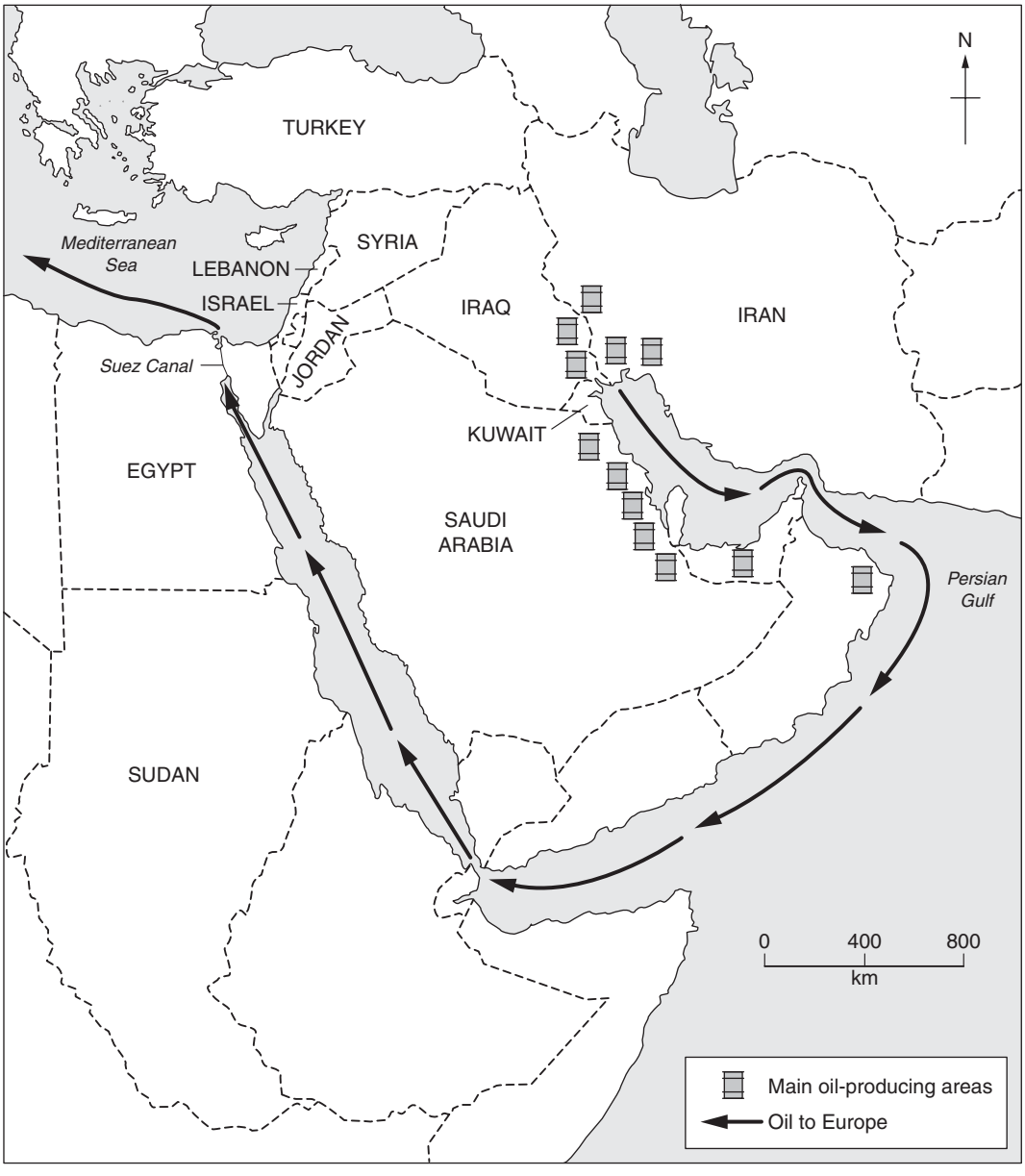


The Suez Canal oil route from the Middle East to Europe.

Many Egyptians blamed their government and, in particular, King Farouk for their country's weakness. They felt the King's government was manipulated by the British. Some Egyptians, especially in the army, blamed the government for their defeat by the Israelis in 1949. Many of the younger army officers accused the authorities of supplying them with poor equipment and incompetent commanders.